



Loose-fitting clothes allow the participant to jump and move freely.

Parkour

The sport of parkour was founded in the Paris suburbs in the 1980s. It is a way of moving freely over urban terrain by running, jumping, and climbing.



Côte d'Azur

Beautiful resort towns such as Cannes, Nice, and Saint-Tropez are located along the part of the country's Mediterranean coast known as the Côte d'Azur.

Sweet treats

French pastries and sweets—such as croissants, éclairs, and macarons—are known throughout the world.



Macarons are almond meringues sandwiched with buttercream or jam.

Eiffel Tower

Designed by the engineer Gustave Eiffel, the Eiffel Tower was built in Paris in 1889. It stands 1,063 ft (324 m) tall and was the world's tallest building until 1931.



Fashion capital

Paris has long been known as the fashion capital of the world. It is home to many of the big design houses, including Chanel, founded by Coco Chanel (right) in 1920.



Sunflower farming

Sunflowers are grown across southern France. Their heads are harvested for the seeds, which are pressed for oil.



French perfume industry

France has been known for perfume since the perfumers of Grasse, near Nice, first extracted fragrance from flowers.



Geography: The country is bounded by the mountains of the **Pyrenees** and **Alps** and has **Atlantic** and **Mediterranean** coasts.

History: France was **ruled by kings** until the **French Revolution** of 1789, when the **monarchy** was **overthrown**. The country first became a **republic** in 1792.

Culture: A leader in **art, literature, film,** and **philosophy**, France has world-famous **museums**, such as the **Louvre** in Paris.

Food and drink: Celebrated for its **cuisine** and **fine wines**, the country is famous for its variety of **regional cheeses**.